

THE WRONG HOMECOMING

by

Emmanuel Enivweru

01/19/2026

Revision: Fifth

When spoiled rich kid Steven Wellington is banished by his iron willed billionaire mother after a public meltdown over his gold digging girlfriend, he expects to be welcomed back into the arms of his real family , the ultra-wealthy Dantatas, whose name he believes is his birthright.

But instead of private jets and gated mansions, Steven finds himself stranded in a crumbling Lagos tenement with Bimbo, a humble market woman who gave him up for adoption 22 years ago and her skeptical, hardworking husband, Ladipo, who wants nothing to do with this entitled "prince of poverty."

Forced to trade designer threads for dish duty and Instagram clout for sack carrying labor, Steven must confront a brutal truth: blood doesn't make family love, sacrifice, and shared struggle do.

As he slowly earns his place in their world, learning humility, purpose, and the real meaning of wealth, he discovers that his adoptive mother's latest business deal threatens to demolish the very home he's finally learned to call his own.

Now, torn between two mothers, two worlds, and the man he used to be versus the man he's becoming, Steven must choose: Will he fight for the family that raised him... or the one that built him?

A sharp, heartfelt, and socially layered Nollywood dramedy, The Wrong Homecoming blends biting class satire, emotional depth, and authentic Nigerian humor in a story about identity, redemption, and the messy, beautiful truth that sometimes the wrong home is exactly where you belong.

enivweruu@gmail.com

09069437250

EXT. ESTATE ROAD - DAY

A mint-green JEEP cruises through the estate.

ANAYO (30s), burly and exhausted, peeks out the window. In the backseat, STEVEN WELLINGTON (22) leans out the window like a scout in a war zone.

STEVEN
Can't you drive any faster?!

ANAYO
(sighing)
Okay, sir

The car gains speed. Suddenly—

STEVEN
Wait! Wait!! WAIT!!!

Anayo slams the brakes. Steven's head WHACKS against the front seat.

STEVEN
Are you crazy? You want to blind me?!

ANAYO
Ah, Oga sorry o , I did not-

STEVEN
Shut up, you useless fool... Rest assured I'm telling my mother about this.

Steven stumbles out of the car, checking his phone.

EXT. ESTATE ROAD - CONTINUOUS

STEVEN
(to himself)
Right on schedule
(to the car)
What are you still waiting for?
Come out of the car, you old fool

Anayo stumbles out of the car, adjusting his uniform cap.

Across the street, ANNABELLE (20s) and a POTBELLY MAN (40s) emerge from a boutique, laughing and teasing each other.

STEVEN
 (pained)
 Anayo, can you see? Can you see
 Annabelle? That ungrateful witch.
 After everything I did for her,
 she's out here cheating on me

ANAYO
 Sir... what if they are just
 friends?

STEVEN
 Are you sick in the head? Can't you
 see how he's rubbing, pressing, and
 touching her all over?

Anayo observes the duo. They are merely holding hands.

ANAYO
 Oga...I think you should really

Steven ignores him. He reaches into the trunk and pulls out
 a heavy iron CROWBAR. He thrusts it into Anayo's hands.

STEVEN
 Anayo, take it. We'll go over
 there, I'll drag Annabelle, and if
 that frog she's with says anything,
 you use this to teach him a lesson.

ANAYO
 (holding the iron like it's a bomb)
 You mean I should teach him how to
 use it?

STEVEN
 (demonstrating with his fists)
 No! You hit his head, hit his leg,
 his back...even that fat stomach!
 And I'll be on the side kicking
 him, kicking him... we'll make sure
 he faints.

The crowbar CLATTERS to the ground. Anayo raises his hands
 in protest.

ANAYO
 Oga, I no fit!

STEVEN
 Are you a coward?

ANAYO
 Oga, what if he die?

STEVEN
He will not die! Just small
fainting.

ANAYO
With that him big belle? Oga
Steven, you want make I go fight,
but na driver I be o!

STEVEN
What did you just call me?!

ANAYO
Sorry Oga! Oga, my work na to
drive. I am not your bouncer!

Across the street, Annabelle and the Potbelly Man approach
a parked SUV.

STEVEN
They're about to leave. Let's go!

Steven snatches the crowbar from the floor and sprints
across the street.

ANAYO
(hands on his head)
Hey! Dem go kill small Oga today o

Anayo chases after him.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

The Potbelly Man jerks the car door open for Annabelle.

ANNABELLE
(giggling)
Aww, such a gentleman

POTBELLY MAN
Anything for you, babe.

STEVEN (O.C.)
Hold it right there!

Steven bursts into frame, chest heaving.

ANNABELLE
(shocked)
Steven!

POTBELLY MAN
Baby, who is this?

ANNABELLE

Nobody!
(to steven)
What are you doing here?

STEVEN

Annabelle, i gave you my heart!

ANNABELLE

Haba nau! Which heart? Is it the 2
million Naira you gave me? 2
million out of the small 15 million
I asked for?

STEVEN

But I explained this to you nau! My
mother has to give me permission
first! You just started walking
around town with this frog.

POTBELLY MAN

Excuse me, young man. I will not
tolerate any insults.
(to annabelle)
Please, get inside the car. Let's
go.

He tries to open the door wider. Steven slams it SHUT.

STEVEN

You're not taking my Annabelle
anywhere!

POTBELLY MAN

(stern)
step aside.

ANNABELLE

Steven, stop this nonsense. Just go
home!

STEVEN

No! I cannot stand by and watch you
throw our love away.

ANNABELLE

(to herself)
Chai. Where did I even meet this
one?

The Potbelly Man reaches to shove Steven aside. Steven
slaps his hand away and pushes the man hard. The man
stumbles and falls.

ANNABELLE
Steven, STOP!

Steven pounces on the man. With one wild swing of the crowbar, he clips the man's forehead. Blood begins to trickle.

ANNABELLE
(screaming)
Steven, what have you done?! He is
an Army Officer!

Steven freezes. He looks through the car window and sees a MILITARY CAMOUFLAGE CAP sitting on the dashboard.

STEVEN
(whispering)
Jesus.

Steven drops the crowbar and takes to his heels. He runs right into Anayo.

STEVEN
Where are you going?! Back to the
car! Fast!

CUT TO:

INT. GARRE'S HOUSE - DAY

A living room that screams "Old Money." Marble floors, gold photo frames, huge crystal chandeliers.

GARRE WELLINGTON (50s), sophisticated and imposing, settles onto a velvet couch with a glass of expensive wine. Her phone BLAKES. She answers.

GARRE
Hello? Who is this?
(beat)
What?! Where?!
(beat)
Okay. I'm on my way!

She jumps up, grabs her designer purse, and rushes out.

INT. GARRE'S CAR - EVENING

Anayo is driving. Garre sits in the back next to Steven, who is covered in bruises and has a large bandage on his head.

GARRE
Street fighter. Heavyweight
champion. Where was all this your
strength when those officers were
redecorating your face, eh?

STEVEN
He stole my girl...

GARRE
Will you shut your mouth! Which
girl? You think I don't know the
kind of prostitutes you follow?
Good God, Steven, where did I go
wrong with you?

STEVEN
(muttering)
We should sue them.

GARRE
Sue who? Thank your stars we
avoided an online scandal.
(to anayo)
And you, Anayo! What do I pay you
for? Why didn't you stop him?

ANAYO
Madam, I try my best! But small Oga
no dey hear word. He even threaten
say you go sack me!

GARRE
Well, guess what? I'm considering
sacking you right now!

ANAYO
Hey! Madam, no do like that nau.
Abeg!

GARRE
That's enough!

A long, heavy beat. Garre looks at Steven's bruised face.
Her expression softens into motherly guilt. She pulls him
into an embrace.

GARRE
Baby, I'm sorry for yelling. You
scared Mummy to death. Look at how
they manhandled you.

STEVEN
(seeing an opening)
You should call Barrister Harrison.

GARRE
Yes, I'll call him. We will make
them regret this... When we get
home, I'll have the cook make your
favorite meal and the maid will
draw a warm sea-salt bath for you.

STEVEN
And a masseuse. I need a massage.

GARRE
Exactly. A masseuse. Is that okay,
my prince?

Steven nods like a pampered pet. Anayo rolls his eyes so
hard they almost disappear into his skull.

STEVEN
(suddenly screaming)
STOP THE CAR!

The car screeches to a halt.

GARRE
Steven, what is it?!

STEVEN
(pointing out the window)
Annabelle! She's standing by the
roadside! Mummy, my girl is doing
prostitution work

Steven lunges out of the vehicle.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

Steven sprints toward a group of women in revealing outfits
standing under a streetlamp. Annabelle is indeed among
them, looking for her next "customer".

STEVEN
(wailing)
Annabelle! Annabelle!!

Annabelle sees him, her eyes go wide, and she takes off
running in her high heels. Steven chases her. Garre and
Anayo scramble out of the car, running after him in a
chaotic heap.

FADE TO BLACK.

TITLES: THE WRONG HOMECOMING

FADE IN

INT. GARRE'S HOUSE - DINNING ROOM - MORNING

A breakfast spread fit for a king.

Steven sits, scrolling on a new phone. Garre enters, dressed in a sharp power suit.

Anayo hurries into frame relieves Her of her bag.

GARRE
(to anayo)
I'm taking the Lexus today, hurry
up and get it ready.

ANAYO
Ok ma...

He runs off frame.

Garre picks up a tea cup, she quickly pours herself a spot and sips.

GARRE
(notices)
Is that a new phone?

STEVEN
(without looking up)
Mummy chef Benson is getting worse
by the day, this eggs taste sour.

GARRE
(rubbing her temples)
chef Benson has worked for me for
ten years, if you don't like his
eggs, go into the kitchen and fry
yours.

STEVEN
(gasps)
Me? Fry? With my manicured hands?
mom are you okay?
(beat)
Anyways I need 5 million, I want to
rent out a party bus and a couple
of jet skis, I'm going to Tarkwa
Bay this weekend.

GARRE

No

Steven finally looks up.

STEVEN

Did you just say...the 'N' word?

GARRE

I said No...after last week's incident with your prostitute of a girlfriend, I've decided to stop enabling your excesses...from now on you are on a budget.

Takes one last sip of tea, cleans up and grabs her purse.

Steven stands up.

STEVEN

(laughs)

Budget? What does that even mean?

Garre ignores him, turns to leave

STEVEN

You can't just walk away...I didn't ask to be born you know, the least you can do is make sure I am well taken care of, YOU OWE IT TO ME! As my mother.

GARRE

I owe you nothing

STEVEN

you can't just tell me no.

Garre stares at him for a moment.

GARRE

No...

(turns to face him, making stern eye contact)

No again ... No 5 million or any million, No beaches, as a matter of fact I'm freezing your cards, No allowances untill you learn to BEHAVE.

Garre walks out. Steven stares at his cold eggs, confused.

STEVEN

Is this some sort of sick PRANK?!

CUT TO:

INT. GARRE'S HOUSE - LATER

Garre is sitting sorting out a pile of documents.

Steven rushes in, all sweaty and ruffled.

STEVEN

Mummy! I was embarrassed at the
mall!, people were looking at me
like I'm a commoner!

Garre takes a glance at him.

STEVEN

Mummy for the first time ever, my
cards were declined, DECLINED!

He pulls out three atm cards and spreads them on the table
before Garre.

GARRE

Because I blocked them, I've also
revoked your access to the family
trust fund...

STEVEN

(shouts)
What?!!!

GARRE

One last thing...hand over your
phone, all of them.

She stretches out her palm.

STEVEN

(clutching his phone)
You'll have to kill me first!

GARRE

ANAYO!

Anayo peeks from behind a curtain before he enters the
room. He looks at Steven, then at Garre. He lunges and
wrestles the phones away from Steven.

STEVEN

Anayo! You Judas! You traitor!

Anayo hands the phones to Garre.

STEVEN
How can you be this wicked! to your
own flesh and blood!

Garre has had enough.

GARRE
(stern irritated)
GO TO YOUR ROOM! and if you step a
single foot outside this building,
so help me God I'll cut you off for
good!

A BEAT

STEVEN
I hate you!

He charges out of the room.

ANAYO
(giggles, excited)
Madam no mind am o, you're doing
the right thing.

He gives her a thumbs up.

As he seems to forget the way to the door.

CUT TO:

INT. STEVEN'S ROOM - DAY

Steven is lying on his bed, staring at the ceiling,
depressed.

Suddenly an old Nokia "touchlight" phone rings from his
pocket, Steven sits upright, he pulls out the phone and
answers.

STEVEN
(into phone)
Hello? My love

INTERCUT:

INT. BEDROOM - SAME TIME

It's too dark to make out any decor, but we can visibly see
Annabelle up close lying down, phone pressed to her ear.

ANNABELLE
(sounding like she's crying)
I've been calling all your
lines...what about the 100k you
promised me, it's like you want me
to die first before you take me
seriously.

STEVEN
I'm so sorry, my mom confiscated
all my phones.

ANNABELLE
Steven I'm dying o, I'm dying, this
thing you're doing is not fair o,
just because you saw me on the road
last week, you've refused to send
the love of your life money.

STEVEN
Don't die! I'll get it! I'll send
you the money , just hold on a
little, trust me, I always
deliver...

ANNABELLE
I'll call you again o.

STEVEN
I promise you'll get it soon.

ANNABELLE
Ok.

She air-kisses into the phone speakers.

Call ends.

Annabelle shrieks with excitement.

A MALE FIGURE shifts into focus, beside her, wraps his arms
around her shoulders and starts planting kisses on her
cheek.

MALE FIGURE
Babe any luck? I'm starving.

ANNABELLE
Don't worry Steven is my sure
banker, the minute he credits me,
i'll buy you chicken and fried
rice.

She giggles.

The duo are all over each other.

CUT TO:

INT. GARRE'S HOUSE - GARRE'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Steven carefully slides the door open and slips in, tip toes across to the wardrobe, checks, the bedside drawer, then under the bed rest and some bags kept loosely on the floor.

He circles round back to the center of the room, exhausted.

STEVEN
(baffled)
Not even a single Naira note

He notices a table at the far end of the room, Garre's framed picture propped up above it.

He hurries over, jerks the drawer open, his face lights up in excitement, he pulls out several bundles of naira.

Stops for a moment to listen and look around, sure no one is watching, he frantically starts shoving cash bundles into his tight pockets, all filled up, he notices a picture of Garre and a 1 Year old STEVEN atop a brown envelope inside the drawer.

He picks up the picture, in surprise.

STEVEN
I thought I had no baby pictures.

He checks the drawer some more, picks out the brown envelope.

He pulls out a document with a government seal. We see a close-up on the text: CERTIFICATE OF ADOPTION.

Steven's face goes from excitement to total confusion. He reads slowly.

STEVEN
(reading)
"This is to certify that the male child... formerly known as... Adekunle Dantata... is hereby adopted by Miss Oghene-Garre Bianca Wellington..."

He flips the page and sees an old passport photograph of a 16 year old girl, below her full name reads:...

STEVEN
Bimbo Dantata?...
(ponders)
Dantata? I've heard that name
before? Dantata?
(eyes wide)
Dantata... Dantata Farms
International...Ahhhh!

Throws the documents on the floor in shock.

STEVEN
(palms over his mouth)
Oh my God I'm a billionaire.

SMASH CUT TO
BLACK:

INT. GARRE'S HOUSE - LATER

Garre comes in shortly after.

Angle on Steven, arms folded, the brown envelope on the
center table.

Garre notices the envelope.

GARRE
You went into my room

STEVEN
When were you going to tell me?

Steven stands up, Garre moves closer.

GARRE
ok, yes I adopted you, so?

STEVEN
Is that all you have to say?

GARRE
What do you want me to say? does
finding out you were adopted make
me less of a mother to you?
(beat)
I've been your only parent since
you were 2, this...
(picks up the envelope)
doesn't change anything, because I
love you-

STEVEN
(yells)
Don't even say that word

GARRE
but I do love you-

STEVEN
You don't, as a matter of fact
you're like the weapon the devil
fashioned against me...it all makes
sense now, no mother would be as
cruel as you have been to me, to
their own biological
child...imagine, you blocked my
cards, you froze all my accounts, I
can't buy new drip, I can't go out,
you ruined my Beach plans, you hate
my girlfriend and now I just found
out that you adopted me away from
wealth, bringing me here to suffer
till I die in poverty.

GARRE
What are you even talking about,
how is the life I've given you so
far anything like poverty.

Steven pulls out the document with the passport.

STEVEN
(pointing at the picture)
This lady here is my biological
mother, not you! and her full name
is Bimbo DANTATA!!!, do you know
who the Dantata family is? they own
one of the 3rd largest Farms in
Africa, check TikTok... Mr Jeffrey
Dantata the grand father owns two
Private Jets!!! Mummy do you know
what it means to own two jets?...
(beat)
you'll not know, because you are
poor and wretched and you want me
to die poor and wretched too,
imagine if you did not adopt me
from these people, Mummy I could
already be driving my own private
jet by now... flying from Soweto to
Costa Rica with my Annabelle.

GARRE
Steven just shut up!

STEVEN
Mummy ... I mean Mrs GARRE, you
cannot silence me!

Anayo runs back into frame.

GARRE
have you gone mad?

STEVEN
I am no longer your puppet, I've
discovered the truth, you're a
liar, a kidnapper! As a matter of
fact once I return to my real
family, I'll spend millions in
making sure you pay for this
UNLAWFUL ADOPTION!

Garre slaps Steven across the face, he staggers and falls
back into the chair behind him.

He grabs his cheek.

STEVEN
You hit me?! You've truly lost your
mind.

GARRE
(loud stern)
I have given you nothing but the
best!

STEVEN
(mutters)
except the truth.

GARRE
in all this your investigation and
delusions...has it ever crossed
your mind that your mother offered
you up for adoption for a
reason?...have you imagined what
life would have been like if I
didn't adopt you into this...
(gestures to the house)
My life, what if you were adopted
by some okada rider or what if you
were never adopted at all- Steven I
never imagined we would be having
this conversation, I'm so
disappointed.

STEVEN
I'm disappointed too!

(beat)
And I'm going to leave... I will go
out there to find my true family, a
family that would treat me like the
king that I am!

A BEAT

GARRE
Ok...fine, go...go find your
family, but remember this, when you
find them, there's no turning back
Steven, you're no longer my son.

She walks away.

Anayo is confused on which direction to go.

STEVEN
What are you looking at?!

ANAYO
Oga I no look -

STEVEN
Will you get out of here!

Anayo hurries out.

STEVEN
(muttering)
Yes I am Steven Dantata! yes heir
to a great fortune and no matter
what anybody says they cannot
change my destiny!

FADE OUT.

FADE IN:

INT. GARRE'S HOUSE - LATER

Garre is typing on her phone, Steven drags his bags into
the living room, all dressed up to leave.

GARRE
Steven you took money form my
drawer, I want it back.

STEVEN
I need it to pay the Taxi

GARRE
(laughs)
Oh, you need a kidnapper's money,
why don't you call your real
parents.

STEVEN
Dint act like this nau.

GARRE
Give it to me

She stretches her palm open wide.

Steven looks down timidly, he reluctantly pulls out a
bundle of cash from his pocket.

She gives him an up-down, her stern resolve seems to melt.

She sighs. Stands up. Walks over to Steven.

GARRE
Honey, you can keep the money.

Beat

STEVEN
But you said you wanted it back,
I'll give it back.

GARRE
If you want to trek, then hand it
over.

Steven is dumbfounded.

GARRE
I've loved you since the day you
came into my life...you can't be
serious about leaving me, not like
this...ok just take your bags back
inside and we'll talk about this, I
promise we'll go see your
biological family together...
please Steven.

A long beat

STEVEN
you're trying to bribe me,. I'm not
falling for this, No, Mummy - I
mean Mrs GARRE, your wicked hold on
me is over... Listen to yourself, I
should wallow here with you when I
now know I have a family that can
afford me a private jet of my own,
make it make sense.

GARRE
(fumes)
You don't even know these people!

STEVEN
Blood is thicker than water...

He drags his bags towards the door.

STEVEN
Have a nice life without me.

He exits and slams the door shut.

Garre stares at the door, a frown etched on her face,
boiling with anger.

CUT TO:

EXT. ESTATE GATE - DAY

Steven stands by the curb with three oversized designer
suitcases. He is sweating and furiously tapping his phone.

A silver Toyota Corolla (Uber) pulls up. The driver, looks
like he's seen a lot of bad days.

STEVEN
(yelling before the car even
stops)
I've been standing here for five
minutes! Five minutes of my life I
will never get back

DRIVER
(calmly)
Oga, the traffic at the gate was-

STEVEN
I don't care about traffic! I don't
care about your life story! Do you
know who I am? I am a Dantata! Your
ancestors should be honored that
I'm even breathing the same carbon
dioxide as you.

DRIVER
(sighs)
Enter make we go, before you use
English finish me

STEVEN
(struggles with his bags)
Don't just sit there like a statue!
Help me with these bags!

The Driver steps out of the vehicle, hurries over to assist him.

CUT TO:

EXT. CITY - DAY (DRONE SHOT)

A sweeping aerial view of the city.

We see the transition from the lush, green, wide-paved
roads of the high-brow estates to the chaotic, dusty, and
tightly packed streets of the mainland.

The music shifts from a posh orchestral score to a fast-
paced, rhythmic Afrobeat.

EXT. RURAL NEIGHBORHOOD - MOMENTS LATER

The Uber crawls through a narrow street. People are frying
akara by the roadside, kids are playing with tires, and the
dust is thick.

The car stops in front of a weathered two-story apartment
building with peeling paint.

STEVEN
(horrified)
Why have we stopped? Did the engine
die?

DRIVER
No. We are here, Oga.

STEVEN
 (laughs nervously)
 Funny. Very funny.
 (suddenly stern)
 Now, take me to the real address on
 the map. THE DANTATA ESTATE!

DRIVER
 Look the phone, Oga. Number 14,
 Adunni Close. This is it.

STEVEN
 (screaming)
 Impossible! Google Maps must be
 having an error, This is a slum!
 (beat)
 My mother—I mean, the woman who
 kidnapped me lives in a mansion.
 Why would my billionaire parents
 live in a place where the air
 smells like goat shit and piss ?

DRIVER
 Oga, if you no come out, I go
 start this trip back and you go
 pay.

STEVEN
 Armed robber...why am I not
 surprised.

Steven snatches his phone, jumps out, looking at the blue
 dot on the map. It's pulsing right on top of the
 dilapidated building.

STEVEN
 (to himself, hopeful)
 Wait... wait. I see what's
 happening.
 It's a TEST. Yes! The real mansion
 must be somewhere else, yes , yes,
 maybe this is just the "staff
 quarters" they use to disguise.
 Very clever,very clever.

He dismisses the Uber with a wave of his hand like he's
 dismissing a servant.

EXT. APARTMENT BUILDING - STAIRCASE - LATER

Steven is sitting on his suitcase in the narrow, dimly lit
 hallway. He's fanning himself with his hand.

STEVEN
 (muttering)
 Very soon, i will be chilling in my
 penthouse enjoying the fruits of my
 family's labour.

Footsteps ECHO up the stairs.

LADIPO (O.C.)
 Bimbo, that local government man is
 a big thief! How can he double the
 shop levy twice in one month?

BIMBO (O.C.)
 Dapo, calm down nau, God is in
 control.
 (holds up a small nylon bag)
 See the fish and vegetables I
 bought today, at least thank God
 we'll be eating something nice

BIMBO (40s , looking tired but neat in a simple dress) and
 LADIPO (40s , wearing a faded polo shirt) turn the corner.

They stop dead when they see Steven and his mountain of
 luggage.

LADIPO
 (suspicious)
 Who be this one? Young man, are you
 lost?

Steven stands up, smoothing his designer shirt. He looks at
 Bimbo, then at the old passport photo on his phone. His
 eyes go wide.

STEVEN
 (gasping)
 It's you. But... why are you
 wearing
 (irritated)
 that?

BIMBO
 (confused)
 Why am I wearing my own clothes?
 (to ladipo)
 Is there something wrong with my
 outfit?

STEVEN
 is he your bodyguard?

LADIPO
 (moving in front of bimbo)
 young man who exactly are you?

STEVEN
 (he thrusts the phone in bimbo's
 face)
 This is you! Sixteen years old!
 Bimbo Dantata! Heir to the
 billionaire Agricultural empire!
 Tell me the truth, where's the
 mansion, or where you
 disowned?...or is this some kind of
 witness protection program.

Bimbo takes the phone, her hand trembling as she sees the
 photo.

BIMBO
 (whispering)
 This is my school photo... from the
 village. Where did you get this?

STEVEN
 (beaming)
 I knew it! Wealth is in the blood!
 Now, lead me to the real estate.
 I'm ready to claim my rightful
 place in the ranks of all the
 wealthy Dantata heirs.

BIMBO
 I'm Bimbo Dantata. But my father
 was a common tailor in the village
 before he died. We don't have any
 estate. We don't even have a single
 wealthy relative, not in my
 father's generation and certainly
 not in this one, I mean I don't
 know where you're getting all this
 from...wait are you a Dantata?

STEVEN
 (smile fading)
 you mean there's no mansion or
 private jets?

Ladipo and Bimbo exchange a glance, she shakes her head in
 refusal.

STEVEN
 What? No... you're supposed to be
 the daughter of the rich Jeffrey
 Dantata?

BIMBO
 (softly)
 There are many Dantatas in this
 world, my dear. I just so happen to
 be part of a humble one.

LADIPO
 (impatient)
 Wait, wait. Bimbo, why does this
 boy have your picture?
 (to steven)
 How did you get my wife's picture?

STEVEN
 (voice cracking)
 Because... because the papers
 said...
 (he looks at bimbo, devastated)
 You gave me up for adoption twenty
 two years ago.

Silence hits the hallway like a physical weight. Bimbo
 drops the bag of groceries. A tomato rolls toward Steven's
 expensive shoe.

BIMBO
 (choking up)
 Adekunle?

STEVEN
 (whimpering)
 I prefer "Steven"... I'd also
 prefer if you were a billionaire's
 daughter... everything about this
 is just wrong.

Bimbo reaches out to hug Steven, he pulls away, Ladipo
 watches in confusion.

BIMBO
 (excited)
 are you not happy to see me? You
 found me, Adekunle you came back!
 (to ladipo)
 Honey my son is back

Ladipo musters a smile.

STEVEN
 My name is STEVEN!...
 (thinking out loud)
 If you're poor and I'm your son,
 what does that make me?
 (beat)

To think I left mummy Garre for this, the two of you?!

BIMBO
I know you're angry but I can explain why I had to give you away.

LADIPO
Why don't we go inside, sit and talk.

STEVEN
God! Hell no! You want me to go inside this dumpster.

LADIPO
(shocked offended)
it's our home..

BIMBO
Your home.

STEVEN
My home is in West View Estate , the prestigious Wellington Mansion, with my adopted mother!

BIMBO
But---

LADIPO
(cuts in)
you're very disrespectful...I mean if you already knew where you belonged, why did you come here eh?!

BIMBO
(to ladipo)
Babe calm down.

LADIPO
What nonsense, I'm not going to stand here and watch him insult us for no reason.

STEVEN
I think we should just pretend this meeting never happened... I've never been so disappointed in my entire life.

Steven grabs his luggage and drags them out of the hallway.

LADIPO
what kind of thing is this?

BIMBO
I think he's just angry that I gave
him up for adoption.

LADIPO
No, he is not, he's a spoiled brat!

BIMBO
He's my son... Our son

LADIPO
You don't even know that, where's
the evidence, one thing is for sure
he looks nothing like you and talks
way worse and delusional than you
are most of the time.

BIMBO
I'm going after him.

She runs out.

LADIPO
No, Bimbo!!!,
(mutters)
people like this only bring
trouble.

CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Steven paces the sidewalk, his phone in hand and bags
stacked by the roadside.

Bimbo walks up to him.

BIMBO
I'm so sorry about everything, if
you could just listen to me for a
moment.

STEVEN
you did nothing wrong.

BIMBO
(surprised)
but I thought you were angry that I
gave you away... aren't you angry?

STEVEN

well I'm angry for sure, I'm angry
that you happen to be the poor
struggling Dantata and not the rich
one, but at same time I'm not mad
at you for giving me up for
adoption , if you had kept me, God
forbid I would have been raised in
poverty...at least my adoptive
mother can afford a decent roof
over my head.

BIMBO

(shocked)

So you're angry at me for being
poor?

STEVEN

Bravo! My dear.

BIMBO

Ladipo was right about you, you're
actually a spoiled brat.

STEVEN

Spoiled with money my dear, I was
spoiled with good money...at least
I don't live in a junkyard like
this.

BIMBO

(snaps)

Now you better watch your mouth! ,
I can't believe I have birth to
someone like you.

STEVEN

Hey, hey, you better just keep all
that to yourself, I don't want
anyone hearing about it, do you
know what such a scandal can do to
my reputation... online?

An Uber speeds into frame , stops in front of Steven, the
driver hurries out to load up his luggage.

BIMBO

If you're going to be this
arrogant, then don't come back here
again...

(tears up)

who so ever adopted you obviously
failed at teaching you proper
manners.

STEVEN

My mother gave me the world, you
and your papar bag marriage husband
cannot even begin to imagine what
it's like... you're talking of
failure, you gave me up twenty two
years ago and here you are still
struggling like a loser. I think
it's clear who's a failure, you
failed at being a mother, you
failed at life too. Nonsense
(to the driver)
Let's go, I can't stand another
minute of this place.

He enters the vehicle. It reverses and speeds away.

Bimbo stands stunned.

Ladipo walks into the frame, she immediately buries her
face in his chest.

LADIPO

Are you even sure that thing is
your son?

BIMBO

(sobbing)
I don't even know.

LADIPO

To each his own, Let's go inside
dear.

Bimbo wipes her cheeks clean as they proceed inside.

CUT TO:

EXT/INT. GARRE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Loud banging on the locked gate, Garre comes out of the
building in her night robe.

GARRE

(calls out)
ANAYO! ANAYO!!

Anayo runs out of the security house, all drowsy.

GARRE

Who's at the gate?

ANAYO
Madam I don't know.

The sound continues.

ANAYO
E be like na small Oga, he done
come back.

GARRE
Open the gate, I'll handle this
myself.

She marches over to the gate, Anayo drags it open.

We find Steven all sweaty and exhausted looking, carrying
his bags.

STEVEN
Anayo help me with the bags, and
tell the maid to get me something
to eat.

He sidesteps Garre, heading towards the house.

GARRE
Where do you think you're going?

STEVEN
My room-

GARRE
I don't remember you having a room
in my wretched house ... if you
don't mind, leave or I'll call the
police.

STEVEN
Mummy you want to arrest your son?

GARRE
You're not my son.

STEVEN
you adopted me legally and I have
every right to enjoy my mother's
hard earned money!

Garre signals Anayo, he rushes in, picks Steven from the
ground and tosses him out the front gate.

STEVEN

Mummy you can't do this, you signed an agreement! you can't throw me out! I'll sue, I'll sue!!!

GARRE

Last I checked you threw me out first...I hope you've found the fame and fortune you went out to seek, Steven Dantata.

STEVEN

It's Steven Wellington, this is my home.

GARRE

go and meet your parents.

STEVEN

I'm not leaving.

GARRE

Ok, don't worry, the police will handle you!

(to anayo)

On no account should you let this man into my house, else it will be your job on the line

ANAYO

Sure sir! I mean ma!

She goes back into the house.

STEVEN

I made a mistake, Mummy! Mom!! Come back!!!

Gate slams shuts. Anayo bolts it from behind.

EXT. GARRE'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Steven checks the time on his phone, it's 8:30pm, he dials a number, the caller ID shows it's "Annabelle".

ANNABELLE (V.O.)

Steven my love

(makes kissing sounds)

I got the money you sent...

STEVEN

Annabelle, I need your help

ANNABELLE (V.O.)
what can I possibly be able to help
you with?

STEVEN
It's an emergency, I'm stranded
outside, I urgently need a place to
sleep, I was thinking maybe I could
come over to your place.

ANNABELLE (V.O.)
You want to come to my one room
apartment?

STEVEN
Yes, if you don't mind.

ANNABELLE (V.O.)
Why not a hotel?

STEVEN
I only have enough money for Taxi,
not lodging, please just send me
the address.

ANNABELLE (V.O.)
Ask your mom for money nau?

STEVEN
She has cut me off.

ANNABELLE (V.O.)
Ehhh, Yawa done gas! Steven I've
always known you were gullible but
not this stupid, how can you even
think to offend that woman... you
just "throw-way" better silver
spoon.

STEVEN
Are you sending me the address or
not?

ANNABELLE (V.O.)
I can't --- better go back and beg
your mother o.

She ends the call.

STEVEN
Annabelle! Annabelle!!
(snaps)
Aaargh!!!

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - BEDROOM - NIGHT

Bimbo and Ladipo get ready for bed, buttoning up nighties, fluffing pillows and setting blankets.

LADIPO
Better forget about this boy.

BIMBO
it's not that easy.

She slips into the bed next to Ladipo, who runs his hands round her body.

LADIPO
I think you look really sexy in that dress.

He kisses her cheeks.

BIMBO
(smiles)
You this yeye man, I know what you want.

LADIPO
(teases. sings)
"I want to flex my love, I want to carry my love away, to place she loves...odoyewu...odoyewu..."

He kisses her some more.

He's now towering above her.

LADIPO
Babe I promise you, one day, our story will change, I'll have a proper business...
(kiss)
A company
(kiss, kiss)
No...a business empire and you'll be my COO... CEO...
(giggles, kiss)
We fly from Lagos to Paris then to London--

BIMBO
To see the queen

LADIPO
To see the queen

Both laughing.

Ladipo grabs the neck line of her dress, working on taking it off.

BIMBO

I don't even know if I should feel
regret or relief about
Adekunle...my son.

Ladipo stops abruptly, his vigour diminishes, he sits upright.

LADIPO

I haven't taken any offense with
your whole wedlock child situation
but you don't have to keep rubbing
it on my face.

Bimbo sits up offended.

BIMBO

take offense for what? you knew I
had a child before we got married.

LADIPO

(stands , yells)

A child that was as good as dead!

(low)

He wasn't in our lives and that was
the best part...we should try and
keep it that way.

BIMBO

for three years we've been married,
three years I've looked for fruit
of the womb, we need a child
Ladipo! And one walks into our
lives and you want me to just throw
him away?

Ladipo and Bimbo are now standing face to face on opposing ends.

LADIPO

What do you think I was trying to
do, before you brought up your so-
called son.

BIMBO

we've been having sex even before
we got married, we've taken drugs,
gone to pastors and herbalists,
what difference does it make if we
don't do it this one time.

LADIPO

Well maybe this is the one that
would get you pregnant.

BIMBO

It doesn't work like that!

LADIPO

(fumes)

well I'm not going to sit around
talking about that boy!

BIMBO

Is it the fact that we are not
having sex right now or is it
Steven that is getting you this
annoyed.

LADIPO

(yells)

Everything!...

(snaps outburst)

this stupid mediocre life! My
mediocre business! my joke of a
home, my failure of a marriage! And
my wife not wanting to let go of
something that would be a constant
reminder of my shortcomings as a
man!

A Long beat

BIMBO

I'm grateful because nothing is
easy and even at our lowest we're
getting it better than alot of
people out there Ladipo.

(tears up)

when you learn to love this
beautiful blessing of a life we
have together, you wouldn't have
the guts to look at me in the face
and call our marriage mediocre.

Ladipo melts, in realization, he's hurt her.

LADIPO
 (mutters)
 I'm sorry...Bimbo, I'm -

He reaches for her. Bimbo shifts away, she stands up and leaves the room.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Bimbo walks into the cubicle of a living room, she's now wearing a wrapper over her night dress, she ransacks the worn out shelf for the house key.

Ladipo comes running in.

LADIPO
 Bimbo wait, where are you going?

BIMBO
 The house is too stuffy, I need some air.

LADIPO
 I'm sorry...I wasn't thinking, I didn't mean it like that.

Bimbo finds the keys.

BIMBO
 (yells)
 Just stop talking! Stop talking
 Ladipo!!!

She's crying now, tears streaking down her face.

Ladipo is weak, he stands behind her.

There's suddenly a loud knock on the door.

They glance at each other. "who Could it be?" type expression.

The knock again, it persists, then it's followed by _

STEVEN (O.C.)
 Mrs Bimbo Dantata! Mrs Bimbo
 Dantata, can you let me in?! It's
 really cold out here!

Bimbo and Ladipo stare at each other for a moment.

LADIPO
 Why is he back?

She holds up the keys.

Ladipo grabs her hand, stopping her.

LADIPO
Wait what if he wants to stay.

A beat

BIMBO
then he stays

LADIPO
What? He insulted you...us.

BIMBO
but it's late and it's the least i
can do.

Ladipo reluctantly lets her go, she jerks the door open.

CUT TO:

EXT. APARTMENT BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Steven wraps his arms around his body, shivering , as he sits on his luggage outside in the cold.

The door creaks as it draws inwards, Bimbo and Ladipo peeking through.

BIMBO
come inside

Steven stands up struggling to drag his bags over.

STEVEN
Aren't you going to help me with my
bags?

LADIPO
Do we look like your servants, get
inside.

Bimbo comes out of the house and grabs Steven's bags, she takes them inside, Ladipo sighs.

Steven enters as well.

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Steven still has his arms wrapped around his body, Ladipo locks the door, Bimbo arranges the bags next to the couch.

LADIPO
Are you still cold?

STEVEN
It's like an oven in here...but the heat is not the problem.

He gawks with irritation etched on his face.

LADIPO
(sarcastic, amused, irritated)
Oh you do not like my house abi?
Too...
(air quotes)
Low key for his majesty the prince?

BIMBO
Ladipo !

STEVEN
I'll manage

LADIPO
You want to MANAGE my house.

STEVEN
(coughs)
Sorry, stuffy, so so stuffy,
(coughs)
Can you open the window?

LADIPO
Didn't anyone ever teach you how to say please?

STEVEN
For a window?

LADIPO
For-

BIMBO
Let me get the window.

She opens the window.

Steven eases.

STEVEN
Ahhh finally, fresh air.
(suddenly smacks)

Jesus mosquito!!!
(beat)
Close the windows!

Ladipo chuckles.

Bimbo dramatically shuts the window.

LADIPO
tomorrow we can continue whatever
this is .

He exits the room.

BIMBO
I didn't think you'd come back. Did
something happen?

STEVEN
you think I'd be caught dead in the
trenches if something didn't
happen?

BIMBO
Whatever it is I'm really sorry,
come you'll sleep here on the
couch.

She grabs a wrapper and hands it to him.

STEVEN
You don't have a duvet.

BIMBO
We do but that's what me and Ladipo
use in the bedroom.

STEVEN
I've never used a wrapper before.

BIMBO
It's just like a duvet...

Bimbo snatches the wrapper and covers the couch up. She
smiles wide.

Steven sits.

STEVEN
I will survive...

BIMBO
try and get good sleep, tomorrow
we'll talk.

She leaves.

STEVEN
What have I gotten myself into...
I've ruined my life.

He curls up into the chair and starts crying.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Ladipo is in bed, Bimbo crawls in next to him and faces the wall away from him.

LADIPO
Did he mention when he intends to
leave?

BIMBO
I don't think he's leaving anytime
soon...I don't even want him to
go...yet.

LADIPO
you act as if he's the perfect son,
I mean a 20 something year old man
is not my idea for our first child.

He sits up in protest.

BIMBO
Ladipo, he is still a kid.

A beat

LADIPO
The only thing I can agree with you
on, in all this nonsense, is that
he's your son, your own, not mine,
you'll be 100% responsible for his
excesses.

He shrugs and turns to face the wall away from Bimbo.

A beat

LADIPO
We can not feed him o.

BIMBO
God will provide

Ladipo is restless.

LADIPO

If he has to stay he better makes
himself useful, I'm not going to do
all the work to feed a child I did
not make.

BIMBO

(sits up)

You're so annoying when you're
jealous

LADIPO

I'm not jealous!

BIMBO

And insecure

LADIPO

Better mind your mouth! And stop
fabricating nonsense!

They both start throwing words back and forth in a heated
argument we can't make anything out.

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING- MORNING

Steven lounges on the couch, doom scrolling, irritated.

Ladipo stands. Bimbo beside him.

LADIPO

If you're staying here, you'll have
to earn it.

STEVEN

I don't want to earn any you guys
own abeg, keep your poverty to
yourself, thank you.

BIMBO

(starting soft)

what my husband means to say is,
you need to help out with small
things around the house...

LADIPO

(interrupting)

Chores. Daily!

STEVEN
(laughs)
Oh please...
(beat)
For real?
(laughs)
I didn't come here to be your
houseboy.
(mutters)
Me? do chores for the likes of you
(hisses)

LADIPO
(stern)
Then go back to your mansion.

Ladipo exits.

Bimbo looks hurt.

STEVEN
(turning to bimbo)
See? This is what you married.

Something snaps.

Bimbo slaps him across the face.

Dead silence.

Steven freezes, stunned.

Bimbo, shocked at herself, turns and walks away.

Steven sits alone.

His eyes fill. He fights it, loses and starts crying.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - AFTERNOON

We pan across the apartment.

- Dirty plates in the kitchen sink.
- Piles of dirty laundry on the floor next to the main door.
- The living room is out of order.

We finally settle on Steven.

Steven is actively playing a video game.

Door opens. Bimbo enters, exhausted.

She stops. Looks around, she walks into the kitchen and comes back.

BIMBO
Steven?

She taps him till he responds.

Steven sits up.

STEVEN
(groans and stretches)
What is it nau, you're ruining my
tournament.

BIMBO
look at this house, it's a mess.

STEVEN
(looks round unphased)
When has it not been a mess

BIMBO
You were supposed to clean up while
we're gone, but you did nothing ,
to make matters worse you ate all
the food!

STEVEN
(belches. counts with his fingers)
I got hungry before lunch... during
lunch and after lunch.

She stares at him.

BIMBO
and did nothing?

STEVEN
I rested... don't you know rest is
work.

BIMBO
Steven before I close and open my
eyes I want to see you in that
kitchen washing those plates.

STEVEN
(snaps)
What is all this sef! Is it a crime
to stay with you people, ehn!

BIMBO
You're still talking?

She takes off her shoe, holding it up about to hit him,
Steven quickly jumps to his feet and runs across to the
other end of the room.

BIMBO
(waving him to the kitchen)
Oya inside that kitchen fast!

Steven runs into the kitchen.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING- EVENING

Bimbo stands over Steven, supervising.

He sweeps the floor awkwardly.

BIMBO
No. Like this.

She grabs his hands. Guides the sweeping.

Steven groans.

STEVEN
I'm not meant for poverty.

She ignores him.

He sweeps sand and dirt into a spot then drags the floor
mat over it.

Bimbo slaps him from behind.

BIMBO
Who are you leaving that for.

Steven picks up a parker and stands shoveling the dirt,
suddenly he collapses flat on the floor.

Bimbo is terrified.

BIMBO
Steven! Steven!!!

She taps him

BIMBO
(panicky)
He has fainted!
(calls out)

Ladipo!

She runs for help.

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING – MORNING

Bimbo hands Steven a small list.

BIMBO

Make sure you go and fill the gas cylinder, then take two buckets from the bathroom there's a jacking pump outside in the backyard fill those drums in the kitchen.

Ladipo is already leaving.

LADIPO

If you like faint again, you'll just die before we get back.

Door SLAMS.

Steven waits for a moment,

Then grabs a backpack from behind the couch, and bolts out of the house.

EXT. GARRE'S HOUSE – DAY

Steven dribbles Anayo, trying to get to the door of the building.

STEVEN

(shouting)

Mummy! Please!

Anayo finally gets hold of him, dragging him back towards the open gate.

Garre comes out , she stands by the door, stares in silence.

STEVEN

Mummy I'm sorry, I'm sorry, take me back, they want to kill me with work! Mummy take me back!!!

She shuts the door.

Another SECURITY MAN from the neighboring building comes in to assist Anayo, as they pick up Steven and dump him outside the compound.

He rapidly bangs on the gate.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

Annabelle walking down the roadside in revealing outfit. A man (customer) approaches her, she stops to talk to him, they're laughing.

Steven staggers into frame, filthy, frantic and almost slumps into her.

STEVEN

Please...Just tonight... Annabelle,
my love, help me, just this night,
please, let me stay at your place.

The customer backs off and walks away.

ANNABELLE

Are you mad?! Leave me alone.

She starts walking away.

Steven drops to his knees grabs her leg.

A beat.

ANNABELLE

(quiet, bitter)
Stop! you're ruining everything!
(beat)
it's like you think I like being
here.
(sighs)
just go.

She steps away.

She leaves.

Across the street Bimbo and Ladipo are searching for him.

We see Ladipo point at him, the duo hurry across the busy road to meet him.

Steven sits on the curb.

They approach.

Bimbo's hand goes on his shoulder,

He hesitates... then stands up and follows them.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING- NIGHT

Bimbo drops a plate of Bread and pap.

Steven stares at it, weak and disgusted.

Ladipo sits beside him eating from his own plate.

Steven shrugs.

LADIPO
You know what's worse than
suffering?

Steven ignores him.

LADIPO
Suffering alone.

A beat.

STEVEN
(quiet)
This food is terrible.

LADIPO
At least you have us to eat the
terrible food with, mind you it's
very delicious, my wife is a chef.

STEVEN
For Pap?

Ladipo winks

Steven reluctantly eats.

Bimbo watches from the kitchen entrance, relieved.

FADE TO BLACK.

FADE IN:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - MORNING

Ladipo is wearing a short leaf shirt, with several missing

buttons, he walks over to the couch and sits with a relaxing exhale.

He seems at peace.

STEVEN (O.C.)
your shirt is missing a few
buttons.

Ladipo's smug expression disappears.

LADIPO
Oh...you

Angle on Steven sitting right next to him on the couch, looking so disheveled.

STEVEN
(points)
Right there

Ladipo slaps his hands away.

LADIPO
How long do you intend to stay?

STEVEN
Well it depends-

LADIPO
(cuts in quick)
Depends on what?

STEVEN
How long it takes for my mother to
accept me back.

LADIPO
you're becoming very comfortable
around here... it's as if you're
not even making efforts to go back
to your mother o... need I remind
you that my rent covers for just me
and my wife, we never budgeted for
20 year old long lost billionaire
sons.

Bimbo enters with a tray and drops it on the center table before them, there's a small jug of hot water, sachets of tea powder, sugar, and a huge loaf of unlabeled bread.

Ladipo rubs his palms in excitement.

He picks up the bread and cuts it into three chunks, while

Bimbo mixes tea for everyone.

STEVEN
you've got to be kidding me, this
is supposed to be breakfast? on
your center table?...

They look at him confused.

STEVEN
(pokes the fried eggs)
Did the fowl vomit this eggs? even
these tea cups are not china
(picks up the plastic cups)
Poverty or not, nobody drinks tea
with a rubber cup...and with cheap
milk for that matter!

LADIPO
if you don't want to eat, fine,
that leaves more for the both of
us.

BIMBO
I can get you another brand of milk
if you don't like this one .

LADIPO
No, no...why are you trying to
please this idiot.

STEVEN
What did you just call me?

BIMBO
Ladipo!
(whispers)
I don't want him to run away again.

Ladipo stands up.

LADIPO
I'm going to say this for the first
and last time, Steven or whatever
you call yourself, I am not begging
you to stay under my roof...it is
not Buckingham Palace but it is
where I stay, you either appreciate
it or you GET OUT!

BIMBO
Ladipo calm down it hasn't gotten
to that.

Steven is dumbfounded.

LADIPO
I'm going to my shop.

He snatches his single strap bag tucks bread into it and storms out.

BIMBO
Ladipo don't do like this nau,
Ladipo! come back, Ladipo!!!

Door slams shut.

Bimbo turns to face a stunned looking Steven.

STEVEN
Nobody ever shouts at me! who does
he think he is?
(beat)
I was just COMPLAINING ---is it a
crime to COMPLAIN again?!

BIMBO
It is not FAIR to complain when you
can manage...you know that we're
not your imaginary billionaire
family, nor your so-called adopted
mother, yet you still act like
this! ... Ladipo is a good man, a
hardworking one and it's not very
nice to have you complain about the
things he struggles to provide.

A beat

STEVEN
(scoffs)
So called? My mother provided
everything for me. Ladipo better
doubles his hustle abeg.

BIMBO
providing everything for a child
isn't what being a parent is all
about...she enabled your rubbish.

Bimbo stands up picks up her handbag, straightens her outfit.

STEVEN
Don't insult my mother!

BIMBO
 Newsflash I'm right here... I'm
 going to do what pays me money, you
 can stay here as usual, being
 useless and annoying.

STEVEN
 alone in this house, with no TV, no
 AC, no junk food to keep busy.

She beelines for the door and exits.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - KITCHEN - DAY

Steven is hunched over a pot, lifting the lid with two
 fingers like it's a biohazard. Empty. He moves to the next.
 Empty. He looks like a man who has never known a day
 without a three-course meal.

STEVEN
 (to himself)
 Not even raw rice or garri? God,
 I'm... I'm actually going to starve
 to death.

He wanders into the...

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Steven is clutching his stomach. He begins rummaging
 through the drawers, with disgust. His hand hits something
 hard.

Under a pile of wrappers, he pulls out a WOODEN SAFE BOX.
 It's old, heavy, and locked with a small padlock.

STEVEN
 (eyes lighting up)
 Aha! I knew they were hiding
 something!

He grabs a hammer from the corner and SMASHES the lock. One
 hit. The wood splinters. He proceeds to pry it open.

Inside are thick bundles of 1000 Naira notes.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - LIVING ROOM - LATER

Ladipo and Bimbo return from work, drained. Ladipo wipes
 sweat from his neck with a handkerchief.

LADIPO
 can you imagine my neighbor brought
 young boys from Enugu-
 (dramatically grabs and drags bimbo
 by the hand in demonstration)
 Those rascals will stand at the
 roadside to be dragging my
 customers anyhow...upon all their
 drama I still sold three bags of
 rice today.

BIMBO
 (laughs)
 that's how they do business in the
 East, if you want to compete with
 an igbo man in market you must
 think like an igbo man...if they
 drag two customers, you drag three
 my dear.

ladipo reaches into his pocket and pulls out a few
 crumpled notes.

LADIPO
 I want you to make small concoction
 rice, then buy two bonga fish,
 let's manage this afternoon, before
 evening we'll think of what we'll
 cook.

BIMBO
 (takes the money)
 I'll buy Fanta from the change and
 -

LADIPO
 (cuts in)
 Where is that your son?

Bimbo looks round.

Suddenly, the door BURSTS open.

Steven enters, struggling to carry four large, steaming
 "Thank you" bags from a high-end restaurant.

The aroma of fried rice and grilled chicken fills the
 cramped room.

STEVEN
 (grandly)
 The King has returned! And he
 brings gifts for the peasants!

He thumps the bags onto the small, shaky table. He pulls out packs of food, cold bottles of juice, and expensive bottled water.

BIMBO
(shocked)
Adekunle? Where did all this come from?

LADIPO
(eyes wide)
This is... this is chicken o?

STEVEN
(tossing a "take away" pack to ladipo)
You guys should sit down...relax and eat ehn...
I wanted to thank you for letting me sleep on your couch even though it's giving me back pains...but I still appreciate it alot.

He smiles wide sheepishly. Then drops an extra three packs on the table and sits down, tearing into a drumstick.

BIMBO
(smiling, sitting down)
God bless you, my son. This is so thoughtful. Dapo, see? Maybe he's not so bad after all.

They start eating. For a moment, it's peaceful. Ladipo is actually enjoying the meal, his guard dropping.

STEVEN
(taking a huge swig of juice)
By the way, Ladipo... that wooden box in the room? You need to refill it. I took everything that was inside to pay for this food, the water and drinks. I'm thinking tomorrow I should get us Chinese food...so when you finish eating you can go and refill the box, add extra five thousand naira this time around.

A beat

Ladipo stops chewing. A piece of chicken falls from his hand.

LADIPO
 (voice dangerously low)
 What... wooden box?

STEVEN
 (carefree)
 The one under the wrappers. I had
 to break the lock you should really
 get a digital safe, by the way.
 Nobody uses cheap Aboki Padlocks
 anymore.

Ladipo SPRINTS into the bedroom. A second later, a CRASH is heard. He walks back out, holding the splintered box. It is empty.

LADIPO
 (hands trembling)
 Steven... do you know what this
 money was for?!

STEVEN
 (wiping his mouth)
 lunch money?

LADIPO
 (yells)
 What?!

STEVEN
 Money for food nau, it's what I
 used to buy all this food, I wanted
 us to eat good.

LADIPO
 (screaming)
 It is that food that will kill you
 there!, You used my hard earned
 savings! Money I wanted to use to
 pay rent!

STEVEN
 (stands up, defensive)
 Why are you shouting? It wasn't
 even that much! My mother gives me
 more than that "chicken change"
 for a haircut!

LADIPO
 (gasps)
 You're calling my rent Chicken
 Change?!...
 (charges at him)
 I will kill you today! You useless,

spoiled brat!

Bimbo jumps between them, pushing Ladipo back.

BIMBO

Dapo, Dapo...Ladipo please! Don't hit him! Please!

LADIPO

(pointing at the food)

Look at this! We are eating our roof! You think this is a joke?!

Ladipo grabs a pack of rice and SCATTERS it across the floor in a fit of rage. He kicks the table, sending the others flying, juice splatters all over the room.

LADIPO

(to steven)

Just because your life is a mess, doesn't mean you should go around dragging others down with you!

(to bimbo)

This is your son? This is the blessing you wanted? He is a curse!

Ladipo storms out of the house, door slams shut.

BIMBO

(turning to steven, eyes red with fury)

I am tired of your bullshit!

STEVEN

(stuttering)

I just wanted...

BIMBO

(yelling)

SHUT UP! Nobody cares what you want, no one asked you to help! We were fine before you came here, nobody asks you to do anything!...You will replace that money, Steven. I don't care if you sell your designer shoes or your kidney. You replace every Naira by the end of the week, or I am throwing you out myself!

Bimbo grabs her purse and walks out after Ladipo, sobbing.

Steven stands alone in the mess. He looks at a piece of chicken on the floor. He slowly picks up his fork to take

another bite, but his throat feels tight.

He looks at the empty wooden box. He slams the fork down and dumps the remaining food on the table, his face twisted in frustration.

STEVEN
(grumbling)
Stupid... poor... people.

EXT. APARTMENT BUILDING - VERANDA- NIGHT

Ladipo sits on a plastic chair, staring at the stars. The neighborhood is quiet, except for the distant hum of a generator.

Bimbo walks out and sits on the ground beside his legs. She rests her head on his knee.

BIMBO
I'm sorry, Dapo.

LADIPO
(quietly)
I was going to surprise you on Friday. I was going to tell you the rent was ready, so we could finally sleep without worrying about the landlady.

BIMBO
you've always been a darling.

LADIPO
(sighs, stroking her hair)
Sometimes I wonder... if we had our own children... would they be like him? So cold? So careless? So stupid?

BIMBO
No. Because we would have raised them with love, not with money. Steven has everything in his pockets, but his heart is empty.

LADIPO
(chuckles softly)
Can you imagine? He said we should get a digital safe. The boy is such a joker.

BIMBO
(giggling slightly)
An expensive joker.

LADIPO
Bimbo... no matter what happens,
even if we sleep under the
bridge... as long as you are there
with this your wrapper and fine
face, I have nothing to worry
about.

BIMBO
(smiling)
We will not sleep under bridge in
Jesus name, stop thinking of the
worse.

They sit in silence, looking up at the same stars.

FADE OUT.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - DAY

Bimbo is sweeping the floor, dust swirling in the morning
light.

Steven emerges from the room carrying a high-end leather
duffel bag. He looks determined.

STEVEN
I'm going out. I want to sell
these.

He unzips the bag slightly, revealing Gucci loafers and a
Versace shirt.

BIMBO
(stops sweeping)
Adekunle, wait. These clothes are
too new to sell second hand in this
area.

STEVEN
who's talking about second hand,
these are high quality designers.

BIMBO
My point exactly, those boys at the
junction... they are sharks.
Please, let Ladipo go with you , he
knows the best place to sell them
at a decent price.

STEVEN

(scoffs)

please I highly doubt even Ladipo has seen real Italian leather, i don't want to end up selling them for peanut prices... just stay out of it, you said I should pay back the rent money, I'll pay back the rent money.

BIMBO

Adekunle is not like that, I was angry.

STEVEN

but you were right.

He struts out before she can protest further.

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - LATER

The door opens. Ladipo walks in, practically dragging a limping Steven. Steven's designer shirt is torn, his face is swollen, and he is shoeless.

BIMBO

(screams)

Eh! Adekunle! What happened?

LADIPO

Your "billionaire" son went to the market to make trouble...if I had not rescued him, those thugs would have reconstructed his entire skeleton.

STEVEN

(wincing)

I wasn't looking for trouble, I only told them the truth, those poor bastards were trying to pay twenty thousand Naira for a shirt that cost me two thousand dollars! I told them to keep their dirty hands off it and buy perfume for their body odor.

BIMBO

Steven!...where are the clothes now?

LADIPO

They seized all of them.

STEVEN

They also stole my phone at the bus stop, why is everyone so aggressive around here...we need to arrest somebody o, we need to sue everyone of them and make them pay for damages.

(about to cry)

they didn't even care to know who I was...a whole me!

(sobbing)

Me...

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - EVENING

Bimbo is sitting on the couch . Steven sits on the floor before her. She dips a small towel into a bowl of steaming hot water and presses it against the bruise on his cheek.

STEVEN

(hissing in pain)

OUCH! Are you trying to boil me alive?

(beat)

Mummy Garre would have called a professional masseuse and used imported ointments to massage it.

BIMBO

(softly laughing)

Masseuse? ointments? Steven, you are lucky o. You're making me wish a millionaire adopted me from my parents when I was younger... imagine importing something from another country just to massage my body.

STEVEN

(calmly)

You don't have to imagine it, I have lived that life... everything was just so tender, just right.

BIMBO

When I was seven, I stepped on a rusty six-inch nail behind our house. My father didn't call any doctor.

STEVEN
What did he do?

BIMBO
He put a knife in the fire until it was red hot. Then he dipped it in palm oil and pressed it directly onto the hole in my foot.

STEVEN
(horrified)
he was torturing you?!

BIMBO
(smiling)
I screamed so loud , birds flew off the trees. but look-
(she shows her foot)
no infection. I survived. Not all remedies need to be tender, we are actually tougher than we look, Adekunle, you don't need expensive oil.

Steven looks at her, really looking at her. He sees the scar. He smiles for the first time.

STEVEN
You know... I actually hate the ointment. Smells terrible.

BIMBO
(giggles)
And I hate the smell of red oil on a hot knife too.

For a moment, they are laughing together. The Mother And Son resemblance is striking.

LADIPO
(walking in from the kitchen)
aww you guys look so good together
(stern)
Now pack up and let's soak garri.

He dumps a bowl of dry garri, sugar and sachet water on the center table.

The laughter dies instantly. Steven's face hardens.

EXT. ROADSIDE - DAY

Steven stands by a dusty road. Annabelle walks up, looking

sexy and glammed up but visibly annoyed.

STEVEN
my love.

He opens his arms for an embrace, moving closer.

ANNABELLE
what is it this time?
(she shifts back avoiding the
embrace)
(she's eyes him)
look at you, you're such a mess.

Steven awkwardly drops his hands.

STEVEN
trenches life...you know what I
mean?

ANNABELLE
Actually I don't know what you
mean... people struggle to go up
the ladder not down the spiral.

She pulls out a small hand held mirror and lip stick from
her bag, she starts applying the lip stick.

ANNABELLE
(smacking her lips)
why did you bring me out here?

STEVEN
(reluctantly)
Annabelle, please. I have never
asked you for anything like this
before... I really love you, from
the depths of my heart and when
everything balances out for me
we'll move in together, but right
now I just need small push, to get
out of this my situation.
(beat)
Annabelle I need a loan. Fifty
thousand. A hundred. Anything you
can spare.

ANNABELLE
(laughs harshly)
Steven, like play, like play you
just fall comot from swag.

STEVEN

It's a temporary setback. Just assist me nau, for the sake of love.

ANNABELLE

Love? Who love help? You think I'll hustle then come and give you money. The rich feed the poor, Steven. Not the other way around.

STEVEN

Annabelle after all we've been through together, did everything we shared mean anything to you?

ANNABELLE

You're even dumber than I think...
(starts laughing)
Steven this our love strong o, love wey dey comot brain.

A sleek Mercedes HONKS. Annabelle smiles, straightens her skirt, and turns her back on him.

ANNABELLE

(strict)
Don't call me again o. No come give my
(lifts her boobs)
BRAND bad name.

She enters the car and it zooms off, splashing dust on Steven's face. He stands there, eyes welling up.

Ladipo walks into frame, watching. He walks up slowly.

LADIPO

Steven... what was that about?

Steven doesn't look at him. He wipes his eyes quickly and walks past him toward the house, silent.

EXT. HIDDEN CORNER - CONTINUOUS

Anayo ducks behind a parked car, watching Steven walk away. He quickly turns and enters a tinted SUV parked in a blind spot.

INT. SUV - CONTINUOUS

Garre is in the back seat, looking pale and anxious.

ANAYO

He is okay, Ma. But that girl,
Annabelle... they're still seeing
each other.

GARRE

(wringing her hands)
Oh, my poor boy. Anayo, look at
this place. The dirty streets. The
noise. What if he gets malaria?
What if they hurt him? Maybe I
should just send him five hundred
thousand or one million
anonymously... for his upkeep.

ANAYO

(firmly)
No, Madam. If you send that money,
he no go ever change, this kind
wayward pikin go inherit all your
money, waste am throway...you need
to hold your heart strong o madam,
make life show am small pepper.

Garre looks out the window, a single tear falling.

GARRE

you're right, just drive. Before
someone sees us.

The SUV peels away quietly.

FADE OUT.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - DAY

Steven lies on the couch, staring at the ceiling. He's
wearing a stained white undershirt and messy boxer shorts,
a far cry from his designers. He looks hollow.

Bimbo enters from the kitchen, drying her hands on her
wrapper. She looks at Steven, then at Ladipo, who is tying
his boots, getting ready for the shop.

Bimbo nudges Ladipo and whispers.

BIMBO

(whispering)
Look at him. He hasn't eaten since
yesterday. Talk to him, Dapo.

LADIPO
 (grumbles)
 As if he likes our food in the
 first place

BIMBO
 Dapo!

LADIPO
 (stressed)
 what

Bimbo motions her head directing Ladipo towards Steven.

Ladipo straps on his bag, then spreads his arms to hug
 Bimbo, she shrugs him off with a frown.

LADIPO
 Stop nau.

Bimbo turns away.

Ladipo sighs heavily. He walks over to the couch, where
 Steven is wallowing. He kicks the leg of the sofa.

LADIPO
 Mr. Billionaire. I'm going to the
 shop.
 (beat. glances at a gawking bimbo)
 I want you to come wiand ...
 assist...me.

STEVEN
 (without looking up)
 Just go away, I'm not in the mood
 for this.

LADIPO
 (to bimbo, shrugging)
 You see? The king is not in the
 mood.

Ladipo heads for the door. But at the threshold, he stops.
 He looks back at Steven's slumped shoulders. He feels a
 pang of something not quite love. He walks back.

LADIPO
 Look at me.

STEVEN
 can't you just let me be?!

LADIPO

No! as much as I don't like it, you happen to be my step son... it's high time you gave me that due respect...NOT as your step father but as a token of appreciation, for the couch and the food you freely refuse to eat.

Steven slowly sits up, eyes red.

Beat

Angle on Bimbo , eyes wide, surprised.

LADIPO

That girl... Anna or whatever her name is.

STEVEN

(grumbles)

Annabelle

LADIPO

You're crying over her?

STEVEN

(snapping)

I'm not crying. The dust in this house is just entering my eyes..

LADIPO

I've lived in this "dust" for years. A woman who loves you will stay in any dust with you, She would never for once belittle you or call you names, she would always see potential in you even when you refuse to see it yourself...

STEVEN

(quietly)

Annabelle thinks I'm a failure.

LADIPO

A man who is down is not a man who is finished. But a man who stays down? That one is a corpse.

Ladipo reaches into his bag and tosses a worn-out market apron at Steven. It hits him in the chest.

LADIPO

I need someone to help me count new stock. It's not "Lamborghini work," but it pays for everything you like to complain about. Are you coming or you want to be a corpse?

Steven looks at the apron. He looks at Bimbo, who is nodding encouragingly. He slowly stands up.

STEVEN

how much is the salary?

LADIPO

Don't worry, after I deduct the rent money you ate, you'll still have enough.

STEVEN

Enough to do what?

LADIPO

(smiles)

Enough is good.

CUT TO:

EXT.LADIPO'S SHOP - DAY

A small store not too far from the apartment building.

We see sacks of rice, beans, garri, wheat and flour on the varena.

Ladipo shows Steven into the shop, holds up three fingers as if instructing him, then carries a sack and walks off frame.

Steven grapples on to the edges of his own sack, he struggles to get the slightest budge, frustrated, he sits wiping sweat from his forehead.

Ladipo returns seemingly yelling at him, carried another sack and walks off frame.

Steven struggles with his same sack, unable to move it, he squats next to it complaining.

Ladipo returns scolds him again, Steven rips off the apron grumbling as he walks off, Ladipo runs up to him, drags him back into the shop.

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - NIGHT

The door swings open. Steven enters, covered head-to-toe in white powder, panting, he drops to the floor, unbuttons his shirt.

BIMBO
Adekunle! What is this?

STEVEN
(voice cracking)
Your husband is a mad man.

BIMBO
What did he do?

STEVEN
He wanted me to carry three sacks of flour, 3 full sacks...the first bag I carried burst. I think I have flour in my lungs, Bimbo I'm dying.

BIMBO
(hisses)
You're fine...but wait so you mean all day it's 3 bags of flour you carried.

STEVEN
Was I supposed to carry other things, I'm went there to work for money not become a slave.

BIMBO
But the work is what you get paid for.

LADIPO
(walking in behind him)
Steven spent four hours trying to carry just one bag of flour and managed to destroy it...if mistakes like this continue maybe he'll have to go with you to work instead or better still get his own job far away from my shop.

BIMBO
Ah Ahn nau, you know he can't work for anybody else... what if you assign him smaller duties at the shop.

Ladipo eyes her and walks away.

Angle on Steven now lying straight on the floor, wriggling like a fish out of water.

STEVEN
(wailing)
Help! Help me, my waist, my spinal
cord! I can't feel my body!

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - NEXT DAY

Steven is sitting on the floor, his feet in a basin of warm water. He is massaging his shoulders and groaning.

Bimbo returns from work, she stops abruptly at the sight of Steven.

BIMBO
What is it this time?

STEVEN
Ladipo has crippled me...I can't
walk.

Bimbo hurries over to a small drawer and brings a small cup of local balm, she returns to Steven.

BIMBO
(rubbing balm on his neck)
Is it getting any better now?

STEVEN
I don't want to go to that Shop
again, Ladipo is trying to kill
me...can you imagine he asked me to
carry sacks of rice, those small
small ones...they were like a
HUNDRED bags of rice.

BIMBO
My husband doesn't have a hundred
bags of rice in that shop... Steven
I think you're not just used to
doing any actual work.

STEVEN
If I continue like this I will die
O.

BIMBO
(laughs)
You're complaining after just two days, what about Ladipo, Me or even your Billionaire mother, have you ever thought of the work we do every day for years just to make money?... Steven you haven't seen anything.

She hits a bump, Steven squirms.

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - EVENING

Steven and Ladipo are arguing as they enter.

STEVEN
I told you, if we stack the crates vertically, we will save space!

LADIPO
And I said they will fall and break! you don't just know how to do as you're told.

STEVEN
because I'm not a slave!

BIMBO
(intervening)
Ah-ah! Enough!
(beat)
Come and eat

LADIPO
I'm beginning to realize I actually don't like children and I'm thanking God that I don't have any.

BIMBO
Ladipo!

Ladipo walks out of the room.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - LATER THAT NIGHT

Steven is asleep on the table, his head resting on a ledger. He's snoring.

Ladipo enters the house. He carefully slips the ledger from

underneath Steven and peruses through, we can see him smile faintly, Impressed.

BIMBO (O.C)
He's not all that bad is he?

Angle on Bimbo nursing a glass of water.

LADIPO
he's rude... he's... he's
(sighs , defeated)
still a child,
(beat)
with so much potential...

A beat

BIMBO
I know Steven can be a handful, but
I really want him to become a good
man...like the one I married.
(beat)
just do this for me

LADIPO
(dumps the ledger)
You can take a horse to the river
but can never force it to drink
water, you're doing your best to
make up for everything, but you
don't have to kill yourself over
it.

He grabs a wrapper and throws it over Steven.

Bimbo takes his hand as they exit.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - MORNING

Ladipo sits with a small, battered notebook and a patched up calculator. Steven sits opposite him, looking exhausted but clean.

Ladipo counts out some weathered Naira notes. He pushes a small pile toward Steven.

LADIPO
Your salary.

Steven looks at the pile. He doesn't move. He counts it with his eyes.

STEVEN

This is... twenty-five thousand Naira? Ladipo, I've worked for thirty days. I carried more bags of rice than a donkey. This can't even buy a plate of Jollof at my favorite restaurant

LADIPO

(calmly)

Then don't go to your favorite restaurant.

STEVEN

(voice rising)

If you know the kind of money my hands have counted in this life.

LADIPO

Money you don't currently have.

Steven shifts uncomfortably.

LADIPO

(picks up the salary and dumps it back in front of steven)

This is honest money, Steven. My business is a Wholesale provision store, not a Chevron subsidiary. If you want a bigger salary, we'd need to make bigger profit. Until then, take it. Or leave it this is your monthly pay!

Steven stares at the money. He thinks for a moment. He slowly reaches out and takes the money. He stuffs it into his pocket, his face set in a hard line.

STEVEN

We aren't making enough money because your marketing strategy is bad. You're waiting for people to walk past the shop. In 2026? That's terrible.

LADIPO

Marketing strategy ke? I have a big signboard. It says "Ladipo & Sons Provisions." What else do I need? A trumpet?

STEVEN
You can be online, on people's
phones all over the country. Give
me your phone.

LADIPO
(clutching his phone)
Why?

STEVEN
(sighing)
Bimbo!

Bimbo hurries into frame.

STEVEN
please tell your husband I'm trying
to help him. I want to film some
content. We can show the wholesale
prices and post it on social
media, more people will patronize
us.

BIMBO
Dapo, just let him try.

LADIPO
(reluctantly handing over the
phone)
If I see one dance video on this
phone, I am taking that salary
back.

STEVEN
Trust me. You'll see the
difference.

He shifts over to Ladipo, who reluctantly leans to see the
phone screen.

CUT TO:

EXT. LADIPO'S SHOP - DAY

Steven is holding the phone, filming Ladipo who looks stiff
and angry in his best outfit.

STEVEN (O.S)
Smile, Ladipo!

LADIPO
(shrugs)
I am a businessman

Angle on Bimbo standing behind a stressed out Steven.

BIMBO
business men do smile, Ladipo
loosen up for once.

LADIPO
(grumbles)
very soon we'll start doing comedy.

He forces a smile.

-Steven is editing a video with trendy Afrobeat music. We see fast cuts of bags of rice, stacks of noodles, and pictures of Ladipo pointing at the prices with a smooth, professional influencer smile.

-Steven shows Bimbo how to Go Live. She is laughing, waving at the camera.

BIMBO
Come to Ladipo and Son's Wholesale
Provision Store at number 24 Adunni
Street.

Ladipo pushes her aside, so his face can be in full frame.

LADIPO
Hurry o, we're selling at promo
price...Bag of garri, e cheap , e
dey! Bag of rice, e sweet, e dey!
Bag of beans

LADIPO. STEVEN. BIMBO
(in unison)
E dey!

Steven and Bimbo start laughing hysterically, Ladipo is a little confused.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - NIGHT

Steven is refreshing a web page on his phone. His face falls.

STEVEN
Only twelve likes. And three of
them are from fake accounts.

BIMBO
(peeking over)
Twelve? That's more than the zero
we had yesterday!

STEVEN
It's a flop. Nobody saw this...I failed.

He tosses the phone on the table, dejected.

Ladipo enters, carrying a heavy bag, but this time, he's whistling.

He drops a heavy plastic bag on the table. It's full of meat, fresh vegetables, and even a bottle of wine.

LADIPO
(excited)
Why are you two looking like you're at a funeral?

STEVEN
The video failed, Ladipo. Nobody liked it.

LADIPO
(laughing loudly)
Nobody liked it? Steven, six people drove from the other side of the mainland today because they saw our video online. I sold forty bags in three hours! I had to call my supplier twice!

STEVEN
(eyes widening)
Wait... really?

LADIPO
(patting steven's shoulder)
They didn't come to like a video, they came to buy! In fact my hands are tired from counting money, not even from carrying bags.

Ladipo pulls out a much larger stack of Naira. He peels off several notes and hands them to Steven.

LADIPO
This is your Digital Manager bonus, guess what tonight we're cooking something special.

Steven looks at the money. A genuine, small smile forms on his face. He looks at Bimbo, who is beaming with pride.

Ladipo pulls out the bottle of wine.

BIMBO
See? I told you. I knew you'll do great.

STEVEN
(softly)
Thanks, Ladipo.

Ladipo and Bimbo exclaim.

BIMBO
Did you just say thank you?

Steven looks away, a little shy.

LADIPO
Don't thank me. Go and freshen up,
We are celebrating tonight!

He pops the wine bottle open.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - NIGHT

Empty bottles of Star lager and malta sit on the table,
next to the half empty wine bottle.

The remains of a celebration meal are scattered about.
Ladipo is sprawled on the small armchair, snoring loudly
with a toothpick still hanging from his lip.

Steven and Bimbo sit on the floor nearby, leaning against
the wall. The house is quiet. Steven is playing with the
edge of the new Naira notes in his pocket.

STEVEN
(quietly)
Growing up I used to think money
was just... there. Like it grew on
trees. I never knew people
celebrated like this over selling a
few bags of rice.

BIMBO
It's not the rice, Adekunle. It's
the peace of mind that comes with
having your own money... the
satisfaction that you worked for
something and you got it

STEVEN

(looking at her)

Bimbo... You said you always knew
I'd be great... you've always
believed in me...

(beat)

If you felt I'll be alright, why
did you give me away? was I not
worth keeping? or was it for the
same reasons Garre sent me out of
her house...Is there something
wrong with me?

The atmosphere seems to shift. Bimbo looks down at her
hands. The humor from earlier is gone.

BIMBO

(voice trembling)

You were worth more than the world
to me. That was the problem.
Twenty-two years ago, Ladipo wasn't
here. Your father... he died before
you even took your first breath. I
was twenty years old, from a family
that could barely make hands meet,
I couldn't afford proper medicine
or food for a baby, we couldn't
even pay the hospital bills...I had
no one to turn to...

(beat)

When the head nurse suggested I
gave you up, I did , she promised
you'd have a better life...all
these years nothing else comforted
me other than the thought that you
have it better then I could have
ever given you.

STEVEN

my mother , my real mother once
told me that being a parent is more
than providing everything... it's
not enough...

(beat)

As thrilling as being Steven
Wellington is, I have never had
much fun and crazy adventures than
now that I'm Steven Dantata...not
the billionaire Dantata.

Bimbo and Steven laugh.

Steven reaches out and covers her hand with his.

STEVEN
(in a more respectful tone)
I... I'm sorry. For everything I
said.

BIMBO
(wiping a tear)
It's okay. You're home now. Even if
it's the "wrong" home.

STEVEN
this has never been the wrong home
mom.

They hug.

FADE TO BLACK.

SUPER IMPOSED: WEEKS LATER

FADE IN:

EXT. APARTMENT BUILDING - DAY

Ladipo stretches open a new printed sign banner, it reads :
Ladipo And Sons: Second Branch.

LADIPO
I want you to hang this one outside
your shop and your customers will
never get lost.

Steven, dressed in simple, sturdy clothes. He looks fit and
grounded.

STEVEN
Did you make this yourself, it's
beautiful!

LADIPO
You think you're the only one that
can do things with a computer.

A clean Toyota pulls up. Annabelle steps out. She looks at
the building with a slight grimace, then sees Steven. Her
eyes widen at his new look.

ANNABELLE
Steven? My God, you've actually...
filled out.

Ladipo and Bimbo see her and exchange a look.

LADIPO
 (to steven)
 We'll be inside. Take your time.

They give them privacy. Annabelle walks closer, trying to look sweet.

ANNABELLE
 I've been seeing your posts o,
 Steven. The Wholesale King of the
 Mainland? You had 10,000 likes on
 that last video? I didn't know you
 had it in you. I guess you just
 needed a little tough love from me
 to get moving, right?

STEVEN
 (calmly)
 Is that what it was, Annabelle?
 Tough love?

ANNABELLE
 (reaching for his arm)
 Of course. I knew you were a
 winner. And now that the business
 is growing... maybe we can go to
 that new lounge in Lekki tonight?
 Let's just talk...about us?

Steven looks at her hand on his arm. He gently removes her hand.

STEVEN
 Annabelle, you were right about one
 thing. The rich feed the poor. And
 you're poor. Not in your pocket
 o... but in here.
 (he taps his chest)
 and I don't think I have enough
 WEALTH to feed a soul that empty.

ANNABELLE
 (stunned)
 Excuse me? Are you rejecting me?
 Nobody rejects me! For what? This
 life? This... gutter?!

STEVEN
 (smiling genuinely)
 Actually, I have to go. We're
 opening a second shop today. It's a
 busy day for setbacks.

He walks away toward the house without looking back.

ANNABELLE

Steven! STEVEN! You'll regret this!
Bastard! You're nothing but a dirty
market boy!

Bimbo and Ladipo are standing by the door, Steven stops
beside him.

LADIPO

I'm surprised you didn't insult
her?

STEVEN

(mimicking ladipo's voice)
Why should I waste energy on what
doesn't make money?

Bimbo chuckles and pats Steven's shoulder. They shut the
door.

FADE OUT.

FADE IN:

EXT. LADIPO'S SHOP — AFTERNOON

light glints off a heavy padlock as an OFFICER (40s, stern
, uniform) clamps it shut on Ladipo's shop door.

A hand-painted sign now hangs crookedly outside:

"PRIVATE PROPERTY • KEEP CLEAR • WELLINGTON ESTATES"

A small crowd has gathered: shop owners, hawkers, kids on
break. All watching.

Ladipo stands on the curb, clutching his rent receipt like
a lifeline.

LADIPO

(voice breaking)
Sir... sir, this is not fair o! I
paid last month! Look at my receipt
, everything accounted for! You
can't just lock me out like a
criminal!

OFFICER
 (not looking up, scrolling phone)
 You didn't do anything wrong. But
 your landlady? She had three months
 to tell you to move out. But She
 chose to remain silent instead.

LADIPO
 She didn't tell me anything! I saw
 her only to drop the rent, she even
 prayed for me.

Bimbo and Steven jog into frame, breathless.

BIMBO
 (gasping)
 Dapo! What's this?! Why is the shop
 locked?!

LADIPO
 (grabbing her arm)
 They're taking everything. All my
 bags of rice and beans. My entire
 business.

STEVEN
 (scanning the scene, instinct
 kicking in)
 Have you called the Landlady's
 number?

LADIPO
 It's switched off. Like she just
 disappeared.

Steven strides to the Officer, calm, firm and grounded.

STEVEN
 Excuse me. My stepfather rents this
 shop. Can you tell us what exactly
 is happening here?

OFFICER
 (finally looks up, mildly surprised
 by steven's composure)
 Do you own property here?

STEVEN
 No sir. But that man? He feeds
 families with what's inside that
 shop.

The Officer sighs, pockets his phone.

OFFICER

Fine. Listen

(points across the road, then
sweeps his arm wide)

This block, That one, The whole
Adunni Close has been privately
acquired, Three months ago. By
Wellington Conglomerate.
They're clearing it for Wellington
Estates, a luxury housing
residence, lush green fields, malls
and private estate security. Very
groundbreaking development,
demolition will be kickstarting
next week.

STEVEN

(quietly)

...Even across the road?

OFFICER

Every structure, Every stall, Even
the mechanic's shed over there.

STEVEN

wait my own shop is right across.

OFFICER

at least you still have time to
pack your things now.

BIMBO

What about compensation? I mean
there was no formal notice at least
there should be compensation! The
law says-

OFFICER

(cuts in, weary)

The landowners got paid. They were
to settle with tenants. If you got
nothing?

(shrugs)

That's between you and them.

LADIPO

(drops to his knees, voice raw)

My landlady has killed me... after
all that many prayers at her house
she sold me out like okrika.

BIMBO
(to officer, pleading)
Officer...sir...can we... just
retrieve our things from the shop?
Our savings and some of our goods,
please.

OFFICER
(checks watch)
Ten minutes, One trip only, No
heavy bags, or boxes. Only what you
can carry in your hands.

LADIPO
(leaping up)
Thank you, sir! Thank you!

He rushes forward, but Steven doesn't move.

STEVEN
(low, to himself, dawning horror)
Wellington Conglomerate...

Then, louder, almost to convince himself:

STEVEN
Wait. Who did you say bought this
place?!

The Officer turns back. Locks eyes with Steven.

OFFICER
Wellington Conglomerate. Owned by
one Mrs Garre.

A beat.

The street noise fades.

Steven's breath catches.

STEVEN
(whispers)
...Mummy?

He looks past the Officer at the sign: Wellington Estates.

BIMBO
(touching his arm)
Adekunle?

Steven shrugs as he storms off.

FADE TO BLACK.

FADE IN:

EXT. GARRE'S HOUSE - DAY

Steven pounds the iron gate. No one answers.

Exhausted He sits on the driveway, sweat streaking his face.

The gate whirs open. Garre's car rolls out, sleek and silent. It stops a few meters away. Anayo hops out, locks the gate behind him, and gets back in.

Steven stands, brushes dust off his trousers.

Garre lowers the window big sunglasses hide her eyes.

GARRE

I told you not to come back here.

STEVEN

I'm not here to beg you for anything.

GARRE

Then why are you here?

STEVEN

Your company's tearing down Adunni Close.

A beat. She studies him for a moment.

GARRE

Get in.

He does.

INT. GARRE'S CAR - MOVING

Anayo drives. Steven and Garre sit side by side, close, but vividly worlds apart.

STEVEN

They locked Ladipo out of his shop without prior notice or compensation.

GARRE

Compensation was paid to the landlords.

STEVEN
They vanished. Ladipo has lost everything.

GARRE
(irritated)
Who is this Ladipo?

STEVEN
My stepfather. Bimbo's husband.

Garre scoffs softly.

GARRE
Ah, Them.

She swipes her phone distracted, practiced.

GARRE (CONT'D)
Look ... Steven... this deal's been sealed for months. I didn't know you were there. But even if I did... business is business.

STEVEN
It's not just business to them.
It's their life.

GARRE
And what would you have me do? Halt a billion-naira project because your ghetto parents are affected?

STEVEN
No, it's not just them and they're not ghetto!
(a beat)
you raised me mom... And if you ever taught me anything, it's that power comes with responsibility not just profit...you owe it to those innocent people who your company will render homeless.

A silence. The car hums.

GARRE
Well you chose them. Don't act like I owe you loyalty now.

STEVEN
I don't want your loyalty. Just your conscience.

She turns finally meets his eyes.

GARRE
Oh you think I don't have one?

STEVEN
Then prove it!, Stop the
demolition. Or at least let them
move their things and pay them the
compensation directly.

Garre stares ahead, jaw tight.

GARRE
I can't.

STEVEN
You can't or you won't.

GARRE
(sharp)
Don't push me.

STEVEN
I guess I will have to get used to
you always telling me NO.

He unbuckles.

STEVEN (CONT'D)
Maybe I was wrong to think you
could change your mind.

He opens the door.

GARRE
Steven

But he's already walking away.

Garre watches him go, her reflection in the window blurred
by unshed tears.

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - LATER

Ladipo paces the room while binging beer after beer. Bimbo
snatches the bottle, tosses it into the bin as she wipes
dust off the furniture.

He pulls out another, pops the cap with his teeth.

BIMBO
When will you stop?

LADIPO
When the entire world stops using
me as their scapegoat.

Door bangs open. Steven stumbles in, breathless.

BIMBO
Steven! Thank God, we looked
everywhere for you.

LADIPO
Let me guess. You have come to
deliver our eviction notice?

STEVEN
What?

LADIPO
Wellington Conglomerate buys Adunni
Close... right after the CEO's son
moves in? You expect me to believe
that's pure coincidence? You
obviously had something to do with
it and I'm certain it's just a
matter of time before your mother
buys this building and we're pushed
into the streets.

BIMBO
Ladipo, he didn't know

LADIPO
(standing, voice low)
Then ask him where he's coming
from?!

Bimbo looks at Steven as if questioning him.

Steven doesn't answer.

LADIPO (CONT'D)
You see, he has gone back to
report to his mother, he has told
her everything about our shop, our
home, all our secrets!...come to
think of it, you really thought he
would give up all that wealth and
settle for this life of poverty.

He gestures to the entire house.

STEVEN
I went to stop her,
I stood up to her! For you!

LADIPO
Oga freedom fighter, if you
actually did anything, why have
they not called us back to take
back our shops, why are the
bulldozers still outside the
street! you're not a new story,
you care about nothing and nobody
but yourself!

BIMBO
Ladipo just calm down let's talk
this out.

LADIPO
Bimbo he shouldn't be here in the
first place!
(beat)
(to steven)
Why don't you just go back to your
mother!

Steven steps closer, voice breaking.

STEVEN
Because this is my home, my family.

Ladipo looks away. Shakes his head.

LADIPO
you don't belong here.

STEVEN
After everything I've done... I
thought you'd see I've changed.

Ladipo looks away.

Steven's face falls. He turns to leave.

BIMBO
Steven, wait!

But the door slams.

Bimbo turns to face Ladipo, furious.

BIMBO
You coward!

LADIPO

What?

BIMBO

This isn't about Steven. It's about you! You're scared you'll never be enough, so you tear down anyone who tries to be a better version of themselves... you've failed to appreciate our life together, you project and blame everyone except yourself for your own shortcomings!

LADIPO

I built this life!

BIMBO

We, We built it! Together!
(beat, softer)
appreciate that and you don't have to blame me or push Steven away just to feel good...

She clutches her stomach winces.

LADIPO

Bimbo?

She doubles over. Ladipo catches her as she drops to her knees.

LADIPO

(frantic)

Bimbo! Bimbo! what is going on,
Bimbo!

CUT TO:

INT. GARRE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Garre flips through old photos, Steven's birthdays, holidays, smiles.

She stops on one: a picture of them hugging, both radiant.

FLASHBACK - INT. DINING ROOM - YEARS AGO

The dinning room is decorated with balloons and confetti, the long dinner table is cluttered with a feast.

Steven sits at the head, with a shiny birthday cone cap on his head.

Garre clears a small space and drops a cake with over 17 burning candles.

There's genuine excitement in the room.

GARRE
Come on make a wish!

Steven shuts his eyes and says...

STEVEN
I wish these smiles never go away.

He blows the candles away.

Garre hugs and pecks him.

GARRE
(continuous)
and they'll never go away, I'll
always love you my prince.

She pours two glasses of wine and hands one to Steven.

They do a toast. Clinking glasses.

GARRE
To happily ever afters

STEVEN
...to the best mother money can not
afford.

GARRE
(laughs)
I'm blushing.

The duo laugh some more and sip wine.

Suddenly Anayo enters the room with a wrapped gift box, as he approaches the table, he misses a step, he trips and falls with the box, it's contents scatter all over the floor.

He picks up the pieces and dumps them inside the ripped box.

Steven fumes and charges over to Anayo.

STEVEN
Mommy look at what this sniveling
pig Anayo did to my birthday gift.

ANAYO
(standing up)
Oga no vex, na mistake.

STEVEN
Will you shut your dirty mouth.

He slaps Anayo across the face.

Anayo falls back on his buttocks.

STEVEN
You're paying for this...you want
to ruin my special day.

GARRE
Steven darling don't worry, Mommy
is going buy you a new one.

STEVEN
(excited)
Really?!

GARRE
Anything for my dream come true.

Steven hurries over and hugs her.

CUT TO:

BACK TO PRESENT

Garre closes the album. Wipes her eyes.

Anayo enters.

ANAYO
Madam... are you okay?

She doesn't answer.

ANAYO
Steven done change, o.

GARRE
...What?

ANAYO
Oga Steven wey I know, he no dey
think of anybody except himself but
he shock me say he come here dey
beg you make you no do those people
bad... people wey him no even know.
(beat)

Madam... you sent him out to learn.
 And he did. Oga Steven done change
 well well. Na now you suppose call
 am come back home, draw am near
 body again, because come rain, come
 sun Steven na your pikin him be.

Garre breaks. Silent sobs.

Anayo sits beside her. She leans on his shoulder.

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - DAY

Ladipo kneels before Bimbo, holding pregnancy test results.

LADIPO
 You're going to be a mother again,
 to my very own baby! And I... I'm
 going to try to be better, I'm
 sorry about everything, I couldn't
 have wished for a better life than
 what I have with you.

She smiles weakly.

A knock. Steven stands in the doorway.

BIMBO
 (surprised)
 Steven you came back.

STEVEN
 Ladipo called me, he told me he was
 taking you to the hospital...I was
 worried.

BIMBO
 It's fine and Ladipo
 (bumps ladipo)
 Has something to tell you.

LADIPO
 I do?

BIMBO
 Yes you do.

Ladipo stands up timidly and walks over to Steven.

LADIPO

I'm sorry...when things get
difficult I have a bad habit of
blaming people, of pushing them
away and I'm sorry i-i promise it
will never repeat itself
again...I'm more than proud to have
you as my son.

STEVEN

(tears up)
your son?

BIMBO

We're a family. Nothing can take
that away.

Ladipo and Steven hug.

A Honk blares from outside.

They look out the window.

EXT. APARTMENT BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Garre stands by her car no designer clothes, no shades.
Awkwardly ordinary.

Steven walks out.

STEVEN

where's Anayo?

GARRE

I drove myself.
(small smile)
I came to say I'll compensate
everyone on Adunni Close ...
directly. And I want you to oversee
it.

STEVEN

Me?

GARRE

You know the people around here.
You care about the place. And...
you've earned my trust.

Steven stares at her speechless.

GARRE

Also... I'd like to meet your family.

Angle on the building, we see Ladipo and Bimbo standing by the door way watching.

Steven leads Garre towards them

Steven gestures to Ladipo and Bimbo.

STEVEN
This is Ladipo, my father. And
Bimbo, my mother.

Then, to them

STEVEN
And this... is Garre , She's
(beat)
She is my mother too.

Awkward pause. Then

GARRE
So...you're the famous Bimbo
Dantata.

BIMBO
(laughs)
And you're the woman who raised my
son.

A beat. Then they both laugh nervous but warm.

GARRE
We're going to be the best family.

They shake hands. Garre steps inside.

FADE TO BLACK.

THE END